

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ A

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥ 5

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦ 5

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦ 4

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 6 5

♥ 7 2

♦ 10 9 5

♣ A 9 7 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ A J 10 9 8

♦ 8 3 2

♣ Q 8



♠ 9 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ A 7 6 4

♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ A K 2

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K J 6

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears NORTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by North			
Lead: ♦A			

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q 4

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J 10 7 3

♣ K 5

♠ J 8 7 5

♥ Q J 6

♦ 8 2

♣ A J 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6 3

♥ K 10 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q 9 8 7

♠ 10 9 2

♥ 9 5 4 3 2

♦ 6 5

♣ 10 3 2

WEST not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when EAST jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, WEST uses Gerber.

EAST shows two Aces so WEST decides 6NT will be just right.

West

1 ♦

North

Pass

East

2NT

South

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♠

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by East

Lead: ♥ 5

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7
 ♥ K Q 10 9 8 7
 ♦ 5
 ♣ 10 8 6 3

♠ K Q 8 5

♥ J 6 3

♦ 8 7

♣ A Q J 4



♠ 4 2

♥ 5 2

♦ K 10 9 4 3 2

♣ 9 7 2

♠ A J 9 6 3

♥ A 4

♦ A Q J 6

♣ K 5

When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT.

NORTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A.

SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6♣	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ Q J 9 8 7 4
 ♦ J 9 8 3
 ♣ —

♠ 9 7 2

♥ 3 2

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A 10 9 4 2



♠ K Q J

♥ A K 10

♦ K Q 2

♣ K Q 7 3

♠ 10 8 5 3

♥ 6 5

♦ A 7 5

♣ J 8 6 5

EAST expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but WEST gives a positive 2♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

WEST then bids 3♠, showing first round control. EAST tries 4NT (Blackwood) and WEST replies 6♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠A.

EAST bids 6♥, knowing they must lose the ♦A.

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT	Pass
6♣	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♦4			